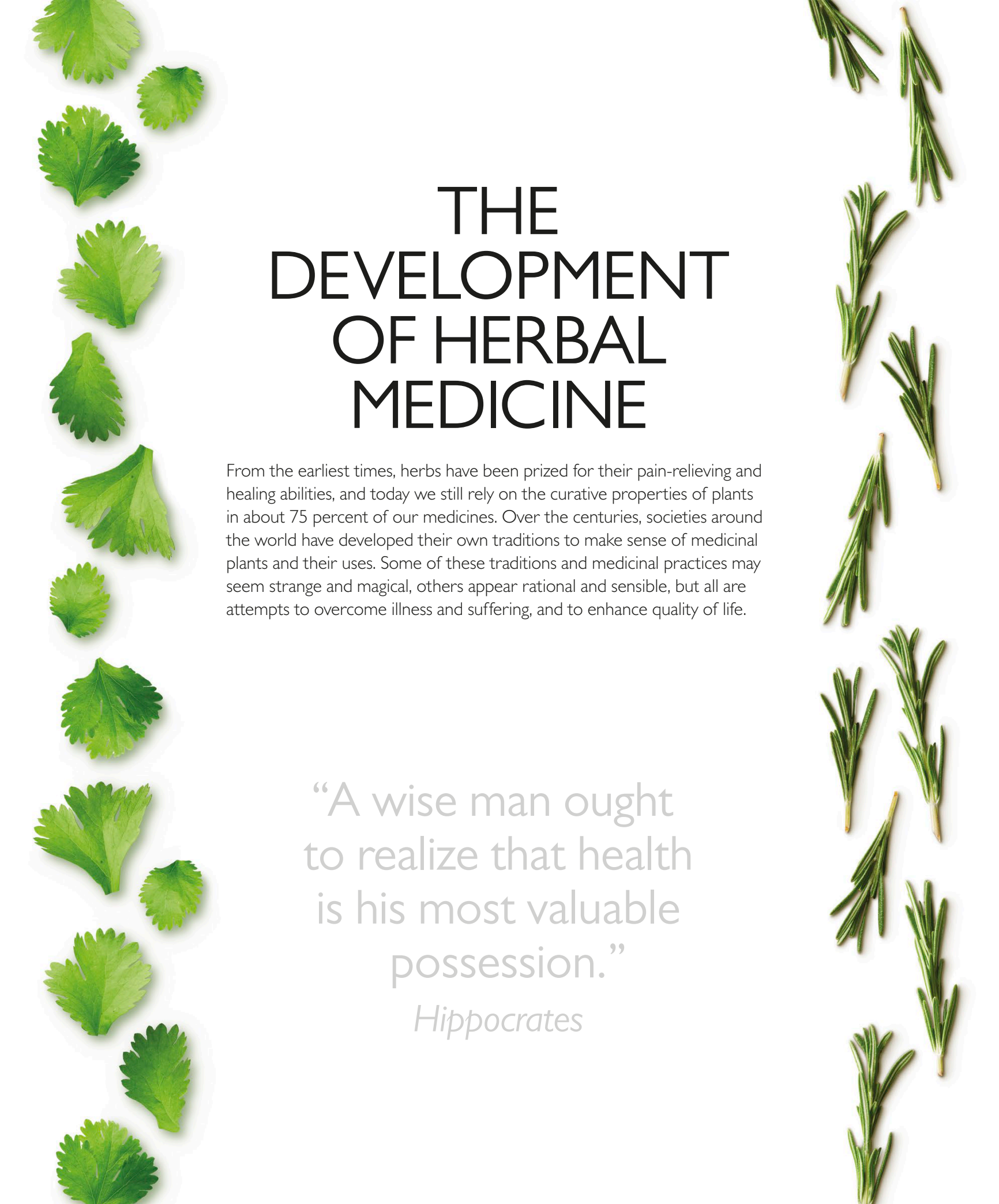


The page is framed by a decorative border of green herbs. On the left side, there are several sprigs of flat-leaf parsley. On the right side, there are several sprigs of rosemary. The herbs are arranged in a vertical line, with some sprigs overlapping.

THE DEVELOPMENT OF HERBAL MEDICINE

From the earliest times, herbs have been prized for their pain-relieving and healing abilities, and today we still rely on the curative properties of plants in about 75 percent of our medicines. Over the centuries, societies around the world have developed their own traditions to make sense of medicinal plants and their uses. Some of these traditions and medicinal practices may seem strange and magical, others appear rational and sensible, but all are attempts to overcome illness and suffering, and to enhance quality of life.

“A wise man ought
to realize that health
is his most valuable
possession.”

Hippocrates